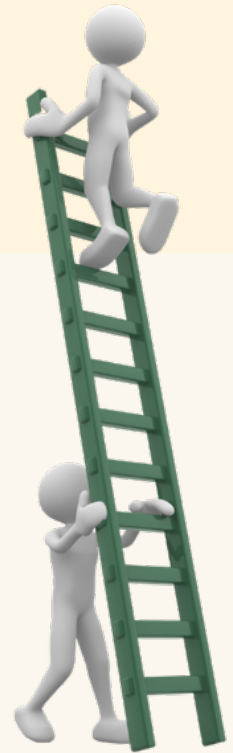


English Ladder

Student Workbook

Understanding the Use of "Recently" and "Lately" in Present Perfect Progressive Tense

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts	Concept #16: Recently/L	Additional Examples for Better Unde	Practice Exercis	Answers:
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Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Understanding the Use of "Recently" and "Lately" in Present Perfect Progressive Tense** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

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Concept #16 ► Recently/Lately

The words '**recently**' and '**lately**' often signal the need for the present perfect progressive tense. This tense indicates something was started in the past, is happening now, and is likely to continue into the future.



This tense is emphasizing how the activity is continuous.
Introducing a specific past period of time is not allowed.

- Recently, I have been dieting.
- I have been dieting over the past few days.
- I have been dieting since last month.
- ✗ I have been dieting last month.

- She has been exercising (ever) since she graduated.
- Lately, she has been exercising a lot.
- She has been exercising (on) Saturdays.
- ✗ She has been exercising Saturday.




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Core Idea

The words "recently" and "lately" are often used to signal the need for the present perfect progressive tense. This tense indicates that an action started in the past, is continuing in the present, and is likely to continue into the future. It emphasizes the continuous nature of the activity.

Quick reference

Present Perfect Progressive Tense	Recently, I have been dieting. This sentence means that the speaker started dieting in the past and is still dieting now.
Present Perfect Progressive Tense	I have been dieting last month. (Incorrect)
Using "Recently" and "Lately"	Recently, I have been studying English. This indicates the speaker started studying English in the recent past and continues to study.
Avoiding Specific Past Times	She has been exercising ever since she graduated. This sentence indicates she started exercising at the time of her graduation and continues to exercise.
Avoiding Specific Past Times	She has been exercising Saturday. This sentence is incorrect because it specifies a particular past time.

Concept #16: Recently/Lately

Present Perfect Progressive Tense

The present perfect progressive tense is formed using the following structure: [subject] + have/has + been + [verb] + -ing

Example Sentences:

- Recently, I have been dieting. This sentence means that the speaker started dieting in the past and is still dieting now.
- I have been dieting over the past few days. This indicates the action started a few days ago and is still ongoing.
- I have been dieting since last month. This shows that the speaker started dieting last month and continues to diet.

It is incorrect to specify a specific past period using this tense. For example:

- I have been dieting last month. (Incorrect)

Using "Recently" and "Lately"



Recently and lately are used to highlight that the activity is continuous without specifying a precise past time period.

Example Sentences:

- Recently, I have been studying English. This indicates the speaker started studying English in the recent past and continues to study.
- Lately, she has been feeling very tired. This shows that she started feeling tired in the recent past and continues to feel tired.
- I have been watching a lot of movies lately. The speaker started watching movies in the recent past and continues to do so.

Avoiding Specific Past Times

Introducing a specific past period is not allowed in the present perfect progressive tense.

Correct Sentences:

- She has been exercising ever since she graduated. This sentence indicates she started exercising at the time of her graduation and continues to exercise.
- Lately, she has been exercising a lot. This shows she started exercising more in the recent past and continues to do so.
- She has been exercising on Saturdays. Indicates that she started exercising on Saturdays in the past and continues this routine.

Incorrect Sentence:

- She has been exercising Saturday. This sentence is incorrect because it specifies a particular past time.

Additional Examples for Better Understanding

- Recently: Correct: Recently, I have been learning French. Incorrect: Recently, I have been learning French last week.
- Lately: Correct: Lately, they have been traveling a lot. Incorrect: Lately, they have been traveling last month.
- General Usage: Correct: He has been reading a lot of books recently. Incorrect: He has been reading a lot of books last year.

Practice Exercises

- Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb: Recently, I _____ (exercise) every morning. Lately, she _____ (feel) very happy. They _____ (work) on a new project since January.
- Identify if the sentences are correct or incorrect. Correct the incorrect sentences: Recently, I have been cooking Italian food. I have been traveling to Europe last summer. Lately, we have been studying for our exams.



Answers:

1. Answers below:

- Recently, I have been exercising every morning. - Lately, she has been feeling very happy. - They have been working on a new project since January.

2. Answers below:

- Recently, I have been cooking Italian food. (Correct)
- I have been traveling to Europe last summer. (Incorrect - Correct: I traveled to Europe last summer.)
- Lately, we have been studying for our exams. (Correct)

By understanding and practicing these examples, you can become more comfortable using the present perfect progressive tense with "recently" and "lately" to indicate continuous actions.



Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with responses consistent with the grammar concepts taught on the left.

ITEM 01

Recently

Answer: _____

ITEM 02

Lately

Answer: _____

ITEM 03

They _____ (work) on a new project

Answer: _____

ITEM 04

For the past few days

Answer: _____

ITEM 05

Recently

Answer: _____

ITEM 06

I _____ (read) this book

Answer: _____

ITEM 07

She _____ (cook) a lot of new recipes

Answer: _____

ITEM 08

We _____ (discuss) this topic

Answer: _____

ITEM 09

Lately

Answer: _____

ITEM 10

Recently

Answer: _____



ITEM 11

For the past few days

Answer: _____

ITEM 12

She _____ (take) online courses

Answer: _____

ITEM 13

Recently

Answer: _____

ITEM 14

Lately

Answer: _____

ITEM 15

They _____ (build) a new house

Answer: _____

ITEM 16

I _____ (practice) yoga

Answer: _____

ITEM 17

Lately

Answer: _____

ITEM 18

Recently

Answer: _____

ITEM 19

He _____ (learn) a new language

Answer: _____

ITEM 20

For the past few days

Answer: _____

ITEM 21

I _____ (improve) my cooking skills

Answer: _____

ITEM 22

Lately

Answer: _____



ITEM 23

They _____ (visit) many museums

Answer: _____

ITEM 24

She _____ (train) for a marathon

Answer: _____



Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

Item 01 have been exercising Feedback: The correct answer is "have been exercising" to indicate an action that started in the recent past and continues in the present.

Item 02 has been feeling Feedback: The correct answer is "has been feeling" to show a continuous action that started recently and is still happening.

Item 03 have been working Feedback: The correct answer is "have been working" because the action started in January and continues.

Item 04 has been raining Feedback: The correct answer is "has been raining" as it indicates a continuous action over the past few days.

Item 05 has been watching Feedback: The correct answer is "has been watching" to indicate an action that started recently and is still ongoing.

Item 06 have been reading Feedback: The correct answer is "have been reading" as the action started last week and continues to the present.

Item 07 has been cooking Feedback: The correct answer is "has been cooking" indicating a continuous action that started recently.

Item 08 have been discussing Feedback: The correct answer is "have been discussing" as the discussion started in the past few days and continues.

Item 09 has been thinking Feedback: The correct answer is "has been thinking" indicating a continuous action that started recently.

Item 10 have been planning Feedback: The correct answer is "have been planning" to indicate an action that started in the recent past and continues.

Item 11 have been feeling Feedback: The correct answer is "have been feeling" indicating a continuous action over the past few days.

Item 12 has been taking Feedback: The correct answer is "has been taking" to show an ongoing action that started recently.

Item 13 have been trying Feedback: The correct answer is "have been trying" as the action started recently and is still continuing.

Item 14 has been studying Feedback: The correct answer is "has been studying" to indicate a continuous action that started recently.



Item 15 have been building Feedback: The correct answer is "have been building" indicating a continuous action over the past few months.

Item 16 have been practicing Feedback: The correct answer is "have been practicing" to show an ongoing action that started recently.

Item 17 has been writing Feedback: The correct answer is "has been writing" to indicate a continuous action that started recently.

Item 18 have been exploring Feedback: The correct answer is "have been exploring" as the action started in the recent past and continues.

Item 19 has been learning Feedback: The correct answer is "has been learning" indicating a continuous action over the past few weeks.

Item 20 has been trying Feedback: The correct answer is "has been trying" to indicate an action that started recently and continues.

Item 21 have been improving Feedback: The correct answer is "have been improving" as the action started recently and is still ongoing.

Item 22 has been driving Feedback: The correct answer is "has been driving" to indicate a continuous action that started recently.

Item 23 have been visiting Feedback: The correct answer is "have been visiting" indicating a continuous action since their arrival.

Item 24 has been training Feedback: The correct answer is "has been training" indicating a continuous action over the past few months.
